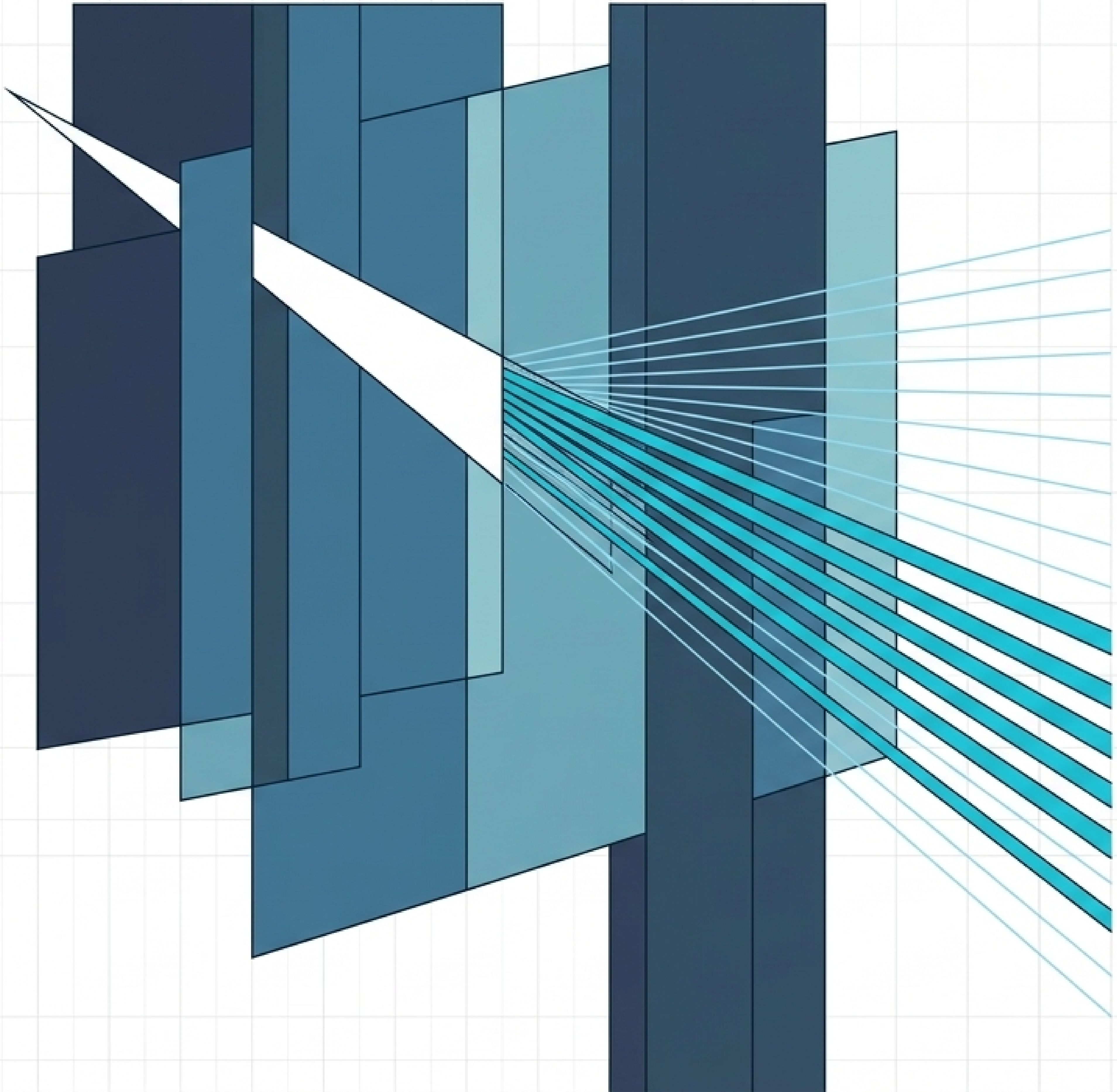


WealthTech 2026: The Era of Execution

Translating technological capability into sustainable competitive advantage.

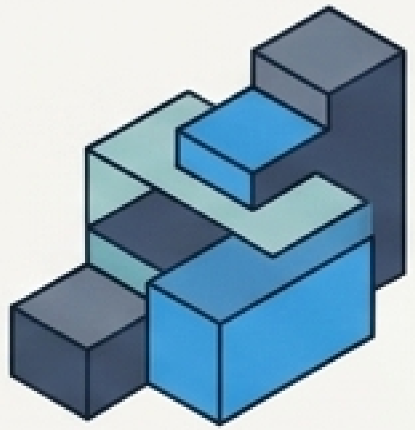
Synthesized strategic insights from The Wealth Mosaic Annual Report 2026.

Moving beyond the margins to the structural core

	The Pre-2026 Mindset	**The 2026 Imperative**
Approach	Siloed point solutions & disconnected tools	Integrated, composable core architectures
AI Deployment	Proof-of-concept pilot programs	Operationally consequential embedded workflows
Value Proposition	Technology as a margin enabler	Technology as the central determinant of strategy
Compliance	Tick-box tracking of static processes	Demonstrable, data-driven client outcomes at scale

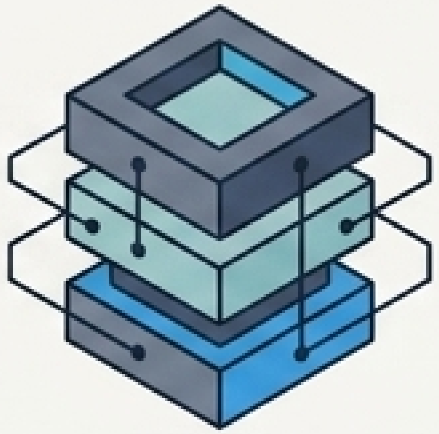
Direction matters now more than intent. The current prominence of technology's role in delivering, enabling, and challenging the industry's norms is unprecedented.

Four macro forces demanding immediate infrastructural scale.



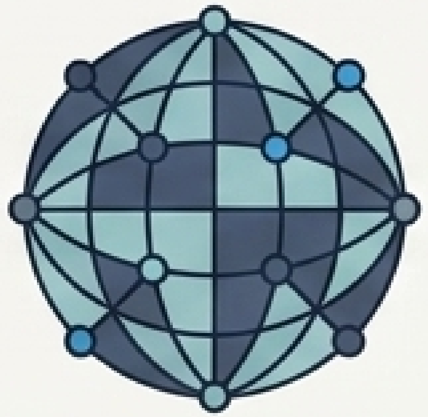
The Decumulation & Transfer Wave

Millennials require heavy, multi-channel digital engagement. Concurrently, retiring Boomers demand sophisticated, predictive decumulation tools to sustainably draw down wealth and leave inheritances.



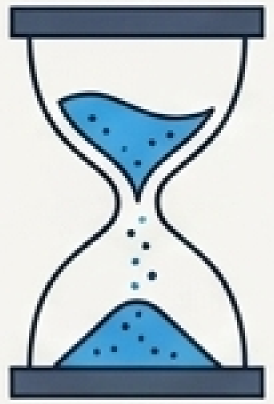
The Alternatives Boom

Clients are demanding access to private markets. This requires complex data modeling to present alternative assets and traditional equities within a unified, single-statement view.



Cross-Border Complexity

Deglobalization and the era of hybrid work have scattered client geographic footprints. Firms require multi-jurisdictional platforms to handle cross-border structuring and political hedging.



The Talent Squeeze

McKinsey projects a shortfall of 100,000 financial advisors in the US alone by 2034. Massive, AI-driven administrative efficiency gains are the only mathematical way to bridge the gap.

Mapping shifting client complexity to required technological enablers.

Swimlane 1

The Ultra-Wealthy	Total balance sheet management across jurisdictions.	Complex entity aggregation and integrated borrowing/ leverage modeling.

Swimlane 2

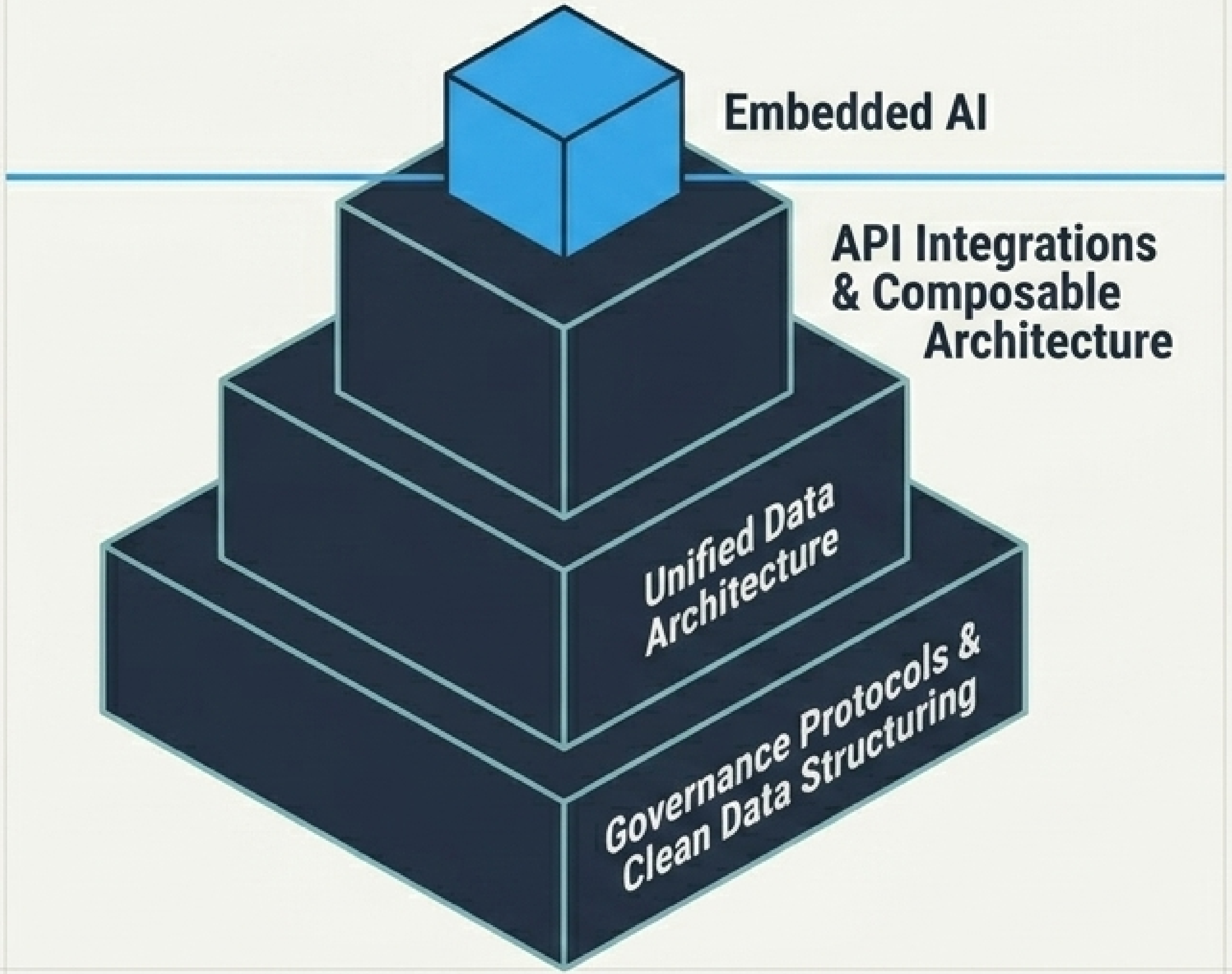
Next-Gen & Philanthropists	Purpose-driven investing and measurable societal impact.	Automated foundation structuring and real-time impact data analytics.

Swimlane 3

Retirees	Sustainable funding for pension years.	Predictive lifecycle modeling and tax-optimized decumulation engines.

The more technology can do, the more clients expect it can do. Yesterday’s ‘wow’ is tomorrow’s baseline requirement.

AI is a stress test of your underlying data maturity.



2026 marks the end of standalone AI innovation initiatives. Advanced capabilities—from advisory support to automated compliance—amplify both systemic strengths and weaknesses.

Without robust data foundations and integrated systems, AI capabilities remain severely constrained. The ability to collect, structure, govern, and activate data consistently across the organization is the mandatory prerequisite for the AI era.

The maturation of the configurable third-party ecosystem.

3,175+
Indexed Business Profiles

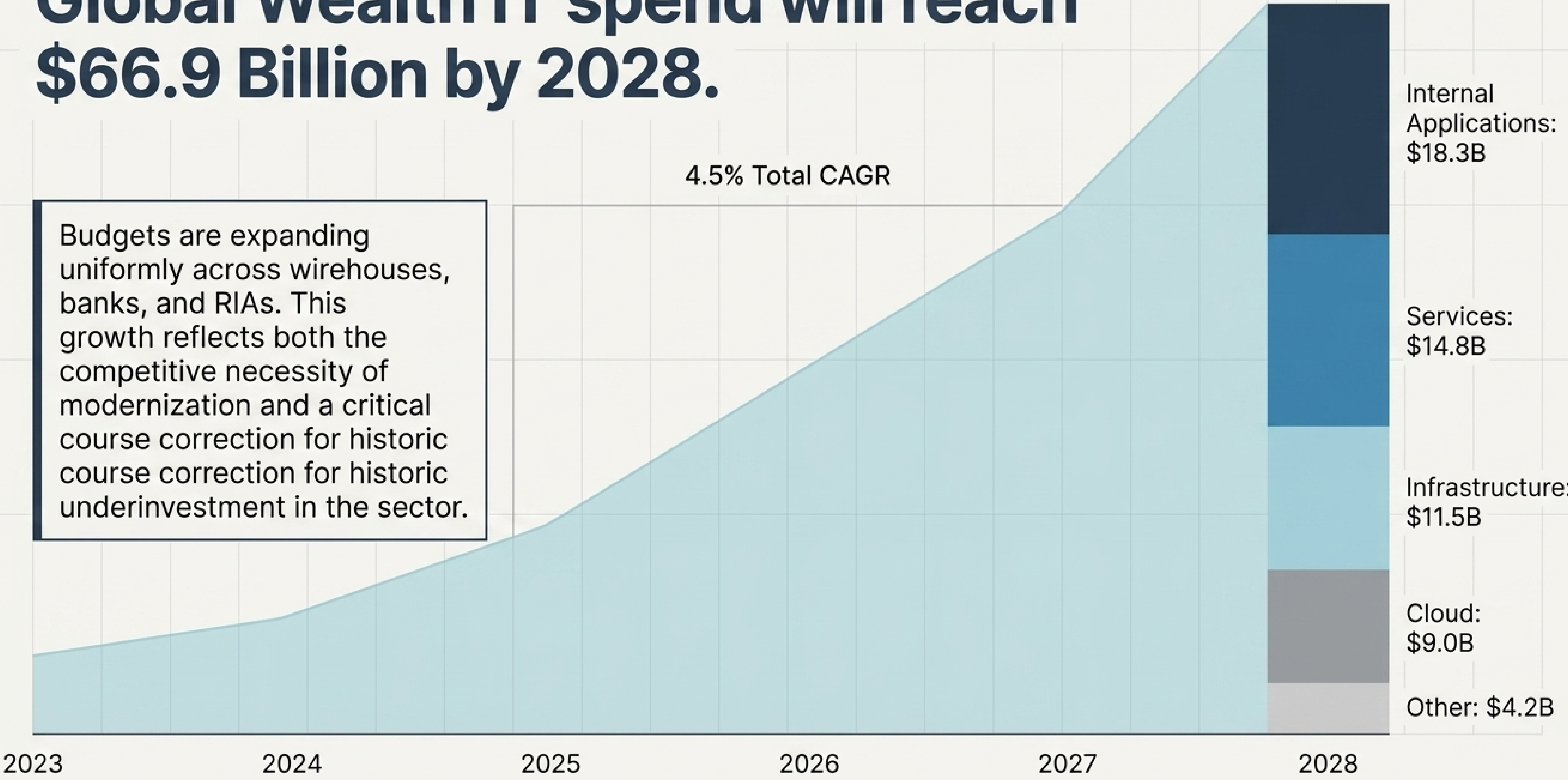
7,000+
Categorized Solution Profiles

39
Mapped Core Business Needs

The sheer volume and maturity of the solution landscape changes the calculus. Long-standing ‘build vs. buy’ debates are evolving into **pragmatic integration strategies**, favoring highly configurable, API-driven third-party platforms over expensive, proprietary internal builds.

Global Wealth IT spend will reach $66.9 Billion by 2028.

Budgets are expanding uniformly across wirehouses, banks, and RIAs. This growth reflects both the competitive necessity of modernization and a critical course correction for historic course correction for historic underinvestment in the sector.



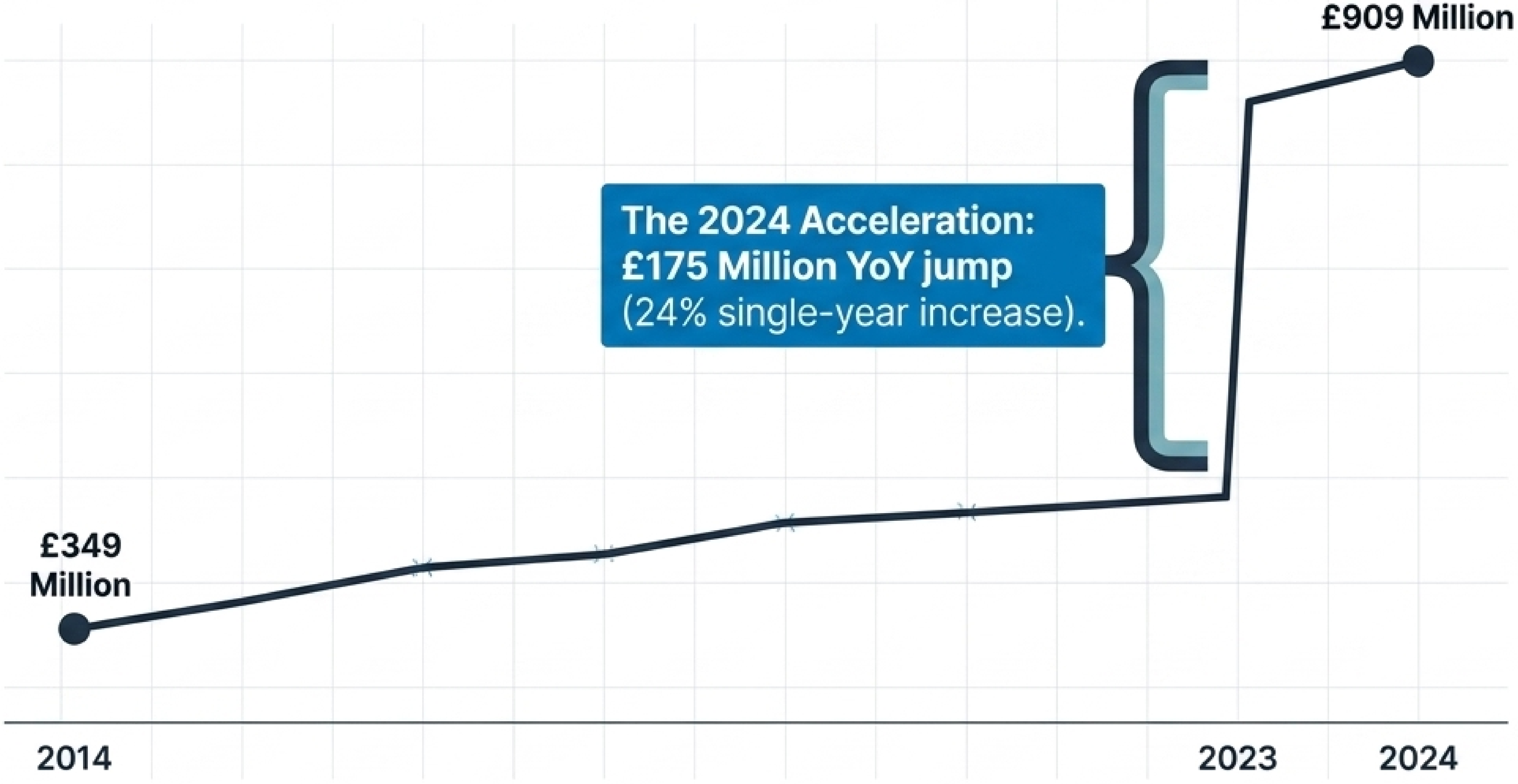
UK non-staff IT spending has trebled over the last decade.

Strategic Context

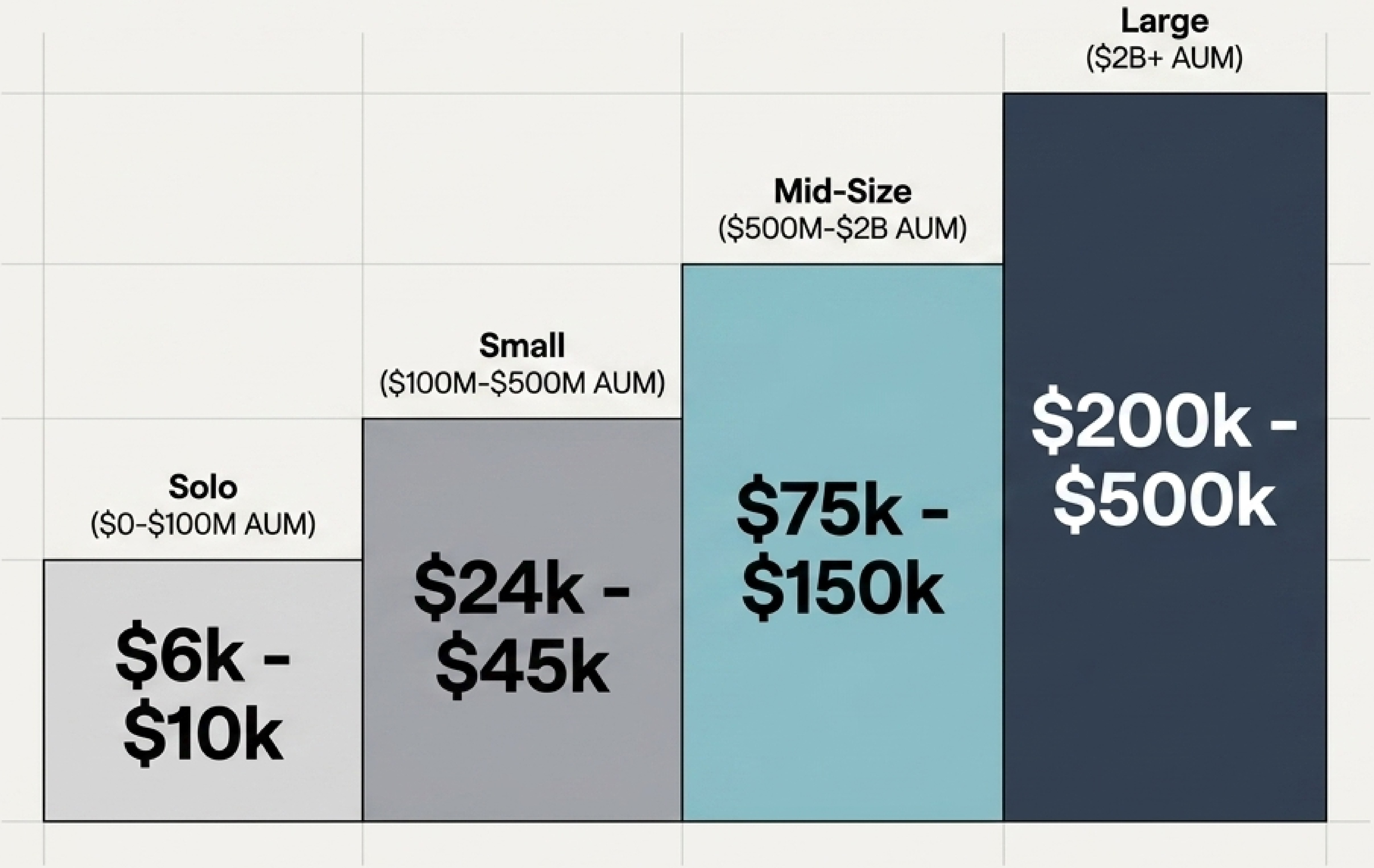
IT spend as % of total revenue (2014) →
5.9%

IT spend as % of total revenue (2024) →
8.8%

Technology is consuming a substantially larger footprint of firm economics.



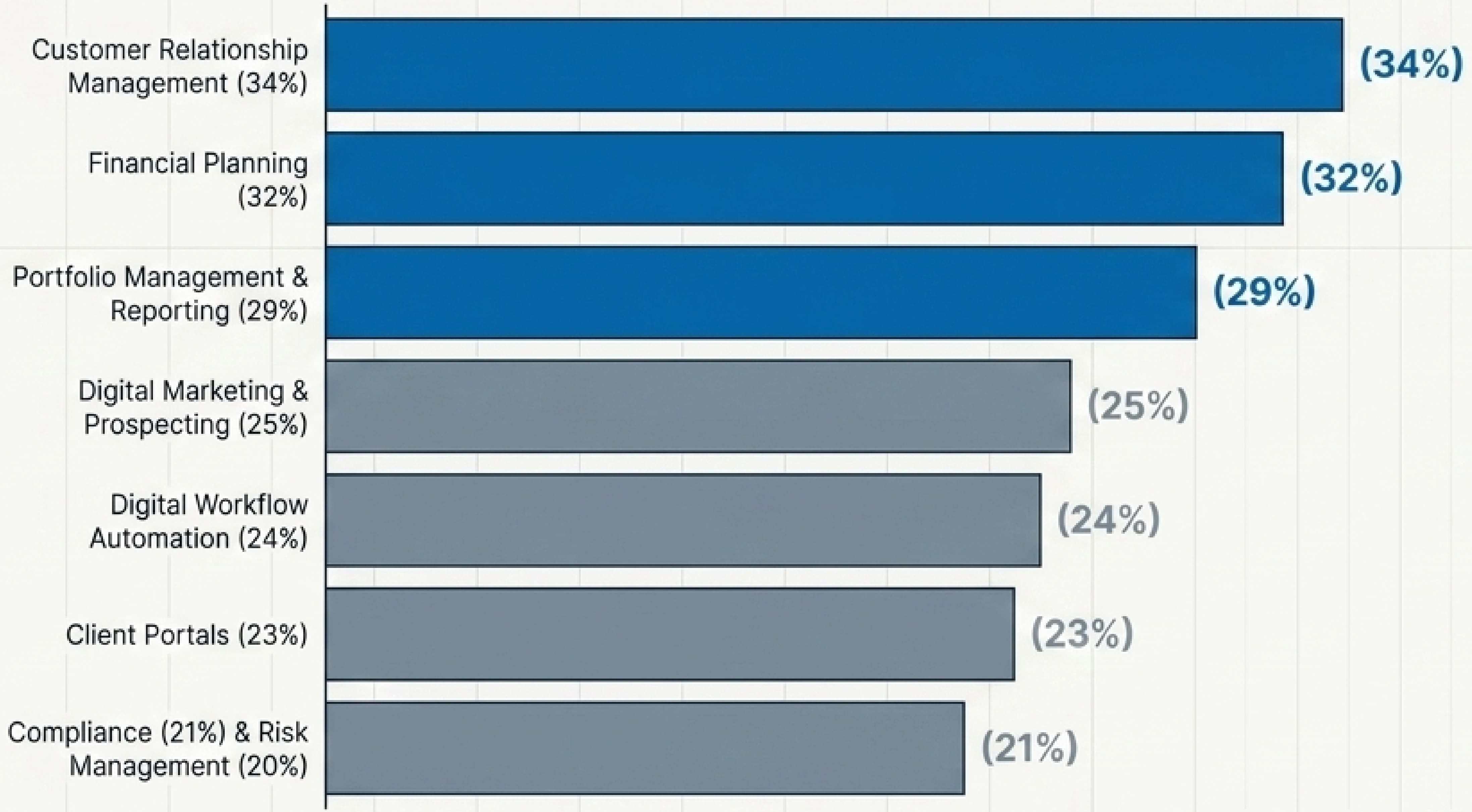
Sizing the 2026 technology budget for US RIAs.



The Competitive Gap

While standard RIAs allocate 3% to 8.4% of revenue to tech, leading asset managers are now dedicating 15% to 20% of their total operating budgets to secure technological dominance.

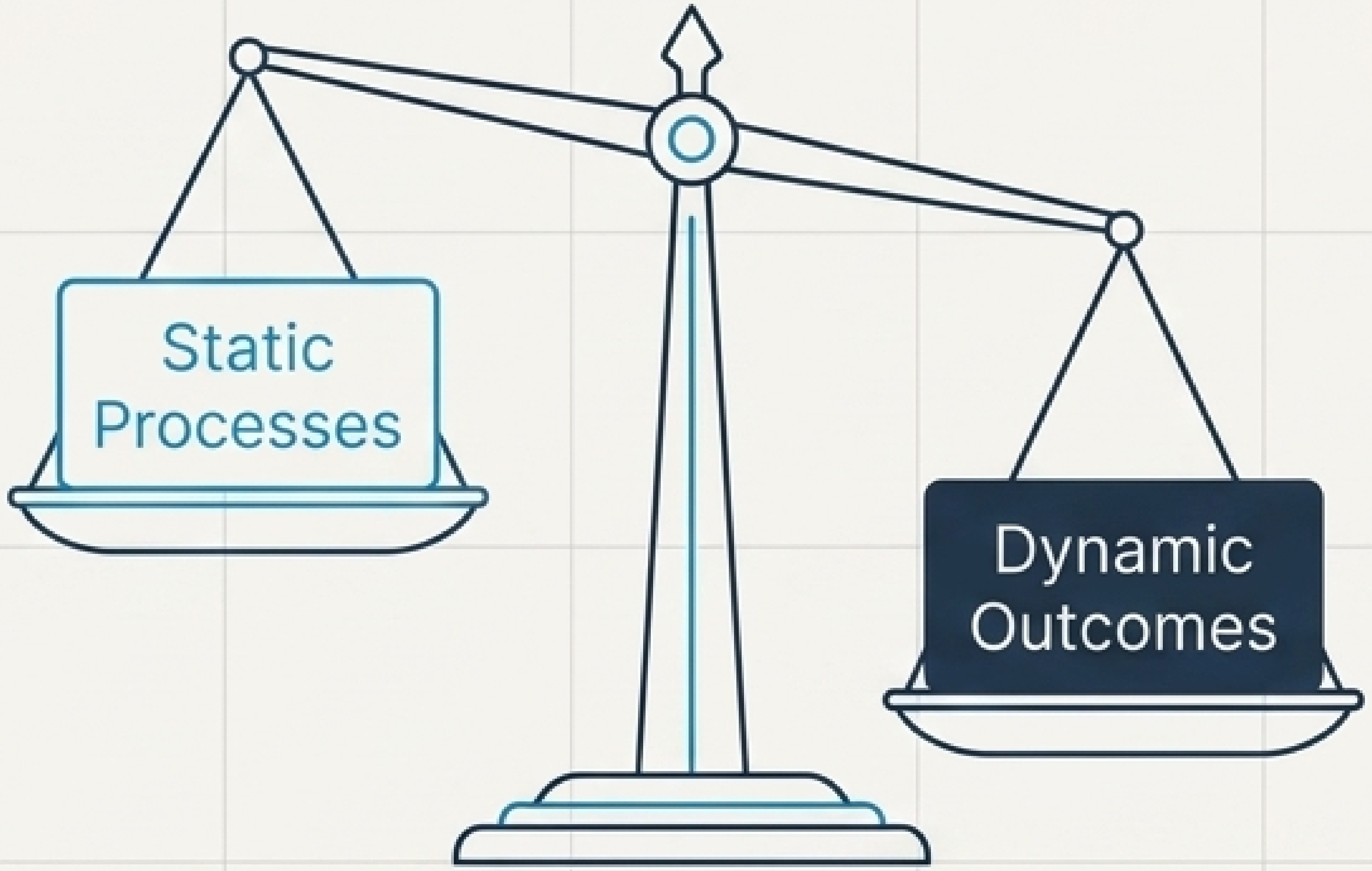
Capital deployment priorities for US firms in 2026.



Synthesis

Spending is aggressively weighted toward tools that directly augment the advisor-client relationship, scale personalization, and consolidate the client view.

The changing face of risk, regulation, and resilience.



Outcome-Based Regulation

Regulators are abandoning static, tick-box frameworks in favor of demanding demonstrable, data-driven client outcomes.

The Explainability Mandate

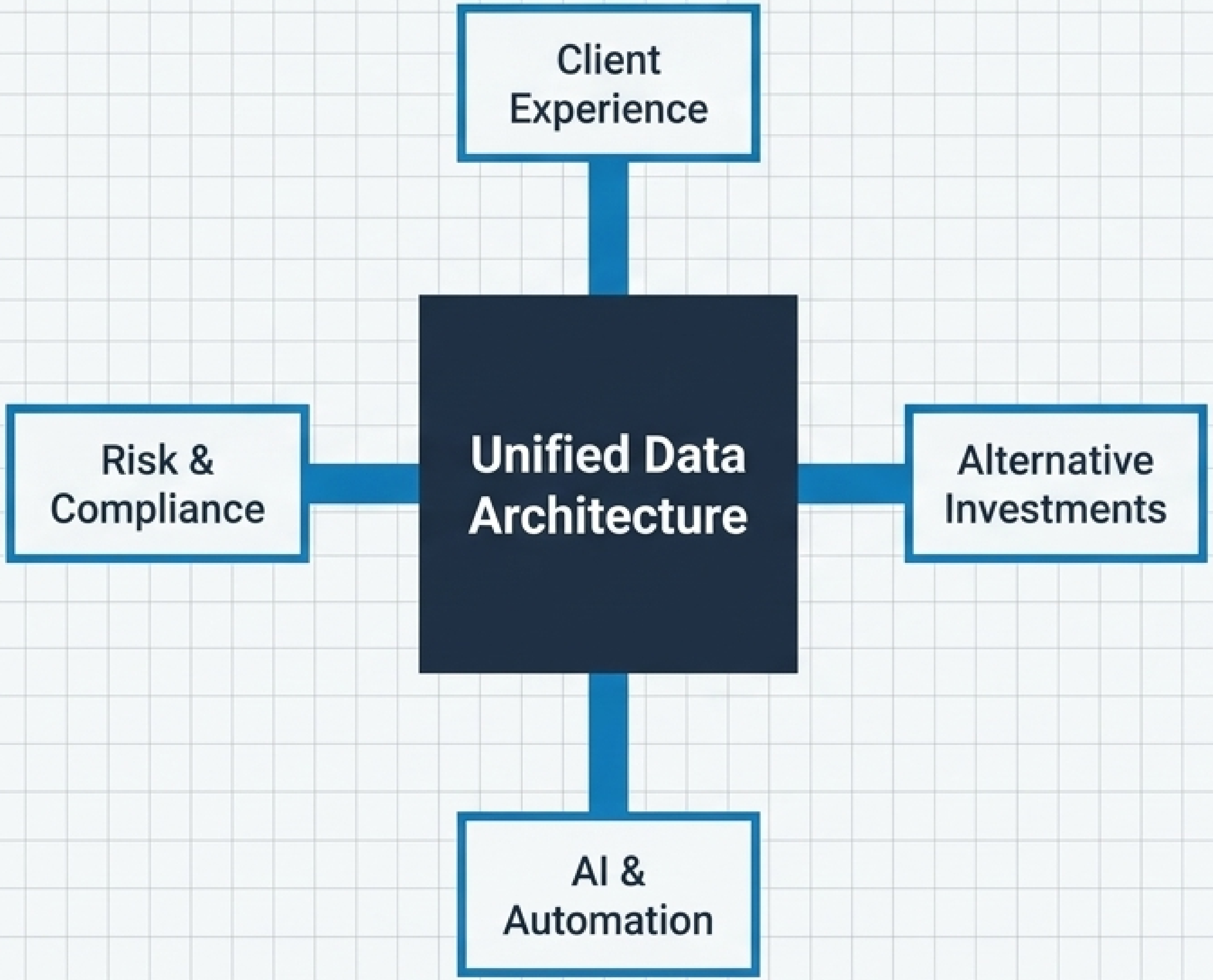
AI adoption necessitates rigorous data monitoring to ensure automated decisions are explainable and repeatable at scale.

The Cybersecurity Threat

Increased digitalization drastically expands the threat surface, requiring highly resilient, well-governed infrastructure.

Compliance is no longer just a defensive necessity. Robust, outcome-focused technology is a competitive credibility marker for boards and clients.

The blueprint for the modern wealth firm



1. Firms must immediately cease accumulating disconnected point solutions.
2. The winners of 2026 will not treat technology as an end in itself, but as an integrated enabler.
3. Every strategic ambition—personalization, private market access, AI efficiency—relies entirely on the integrity of the central data hub.
4. Success is defined by the disciplined execution of integration.

Preparation becomes performance.

The firms that are set to enjoy the years ahead are the ones that have prepared in the years behind.

- Reassess your technology estate strictly through the lens of integration.
- Modernize the architectural core rather than applying surface-level point fixes.
- Focus relentlessly on disciplined execution to turn capability into sustainable advantage.